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PREPARING FOR THE DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

*India is a glaring example of demographic dilemma – while rate of population growth is a matter of concern at one hand, at the other it also unfolds opportunity because children and youth account for a large share of this growth. It is an advantage for India now because the country is entering the demographic dividend phase while China is exiting it – demographic dividend refers to a period, usually, 20 to 30 years – when a greater proportion of people are young and in the working age-group. This cuts spending on dependants, spurring economic growth. India hopes that by the time this dividend phase ends around 2045, it would have achieved a stable and balanced population.**

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* See different reports of the *United Nations Population Fund, United Nations Children's Fund* together with the *Economic Surveys 2010-11/2011-12/2012-13.*